Date: 8 March 2026

To
The Editor-in-Chief
Journal of the Pakistan Medical Association
Karachi
Pakistan

Subject: Submission of manuscript titled "**The Association between Diaphragmatic Thickness and Pulmonary Function in Patients with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease: A Cross Sectional Study**"

Dear Madam,

We are pleased to submit our original research article entitled **"The Association between Diaphragmatic Thickness and Pulmonary Function in Patients with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease: A Cross Sectional Study"** for consideration for publication in the *Journal of the Pakistan Medical Association*.

- Title of the manuscript:
  The Association between Diaphragmatic Thickness and Pulmonary Function in Patients with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease: A Cross Sectional Study

- What is already known on the subject?
  Ans: Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD) is associated with significant respiratory muscle dysfunction, particularly involving the diaphragm. Ultrasonography has emerged as a non-invasive modality to assess diaphragmatic structure and function. Previous studies have suggested that diaphragmatic parameters, including thickness, may be associated with pulmonary function; however, findings remain inconsistent across different populations and disease severities.

- What will the results of your study add?
  Ans: This study provides additional clinical evidence demonstrating that diaphragmatic thickness alone is not significantly associated with spirometric parameters in patients with predominantly moderate to severe COPD. Our findings highlight the limitations of static diaphragmatic thickness as a surrogate marker of pulmonary function and contribute to the growing body of literature emphasizing the need for functional assessment of respiratory muscles.

- How will your results help in clinical practice and or further Research?
  Ans: The results of this study suggest that diaphragmatic thickness should not be used in isolation to evaluate respiratory muscle function in COPD patients. Instead, a multimodal assessment approach incorporating dynamic diaphragmatic parameters and clinical evaluation is recommended. These findings may guide clinicians in improving the assessment of respiratory muscle dysfunction and inform future research exploring more reliable ultrasonographic indicators.

- An explanation of any issues (if any) relating to JPMA policies.
  Ans: The manuscript has not been published previously and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. All authors have read and approved the final version of the manuscript and have agreed to its submission to the journal. Ethical approval was obtained from the Institutional Review Board of Universitas Sumatera Utara (Ref No: 480/KEP/USU/2021), and informed consent was obtained from all participants.

Thank you,

sincerely,

Andika Pradana

Authors' Contribution

Author Name	Contribution
Andika Pradana	Conceptualization, methodology, data collection, analysis, and manuscript drafting
Amira Permatasari Tarigan	Data interpretation, supervision, and critical revision
Pandiaman Pandia	Clinical oversight and manuscript review
Dimas Pangestu	Data collection and manuscript preparation
Nanda Andini	Data processing and literature support